

WINDOWS NETWORKING

Windows features some very useful tools to troubleshoot your network. You can use them to ensure that your network is up and running, and detect problems, as well as find out important network parameters

NetWatcher

NetWatcher is installed with the full installation of Windows 98. If it is not so in your machine, go to **Control Panel > Add/Remove Programs** and click on the Windows Setup tab to install it. Click on 'System Tools' and then 'Details', and then scroll down to select NetWatcher; you will be prompted to insert the Windows 98 CD.

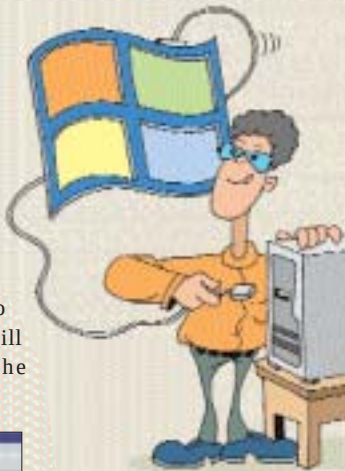


Use NetWatcher to track what resources are users accessing on your machine

NetWatcher lets you see who is using the shared resources on your computer at any given moment in time, across the network. You can use it to add shared folders, as well as disconnect users from your computer or just a specific file. Note that disconnecting the users does not prevent them from reconnecting to your machine. For that, you need to either hide or unshare the specific resources.

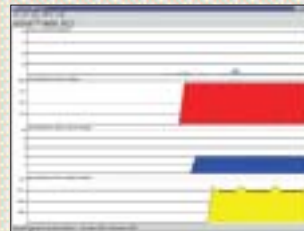
System monitor

System Monitor is a standard utility in Windows. If it is not



already installed, you can install it from **Control Panel > Add/Remove Programs**, here navigate to **Windows Setup > System Tools > Details**. Scroll down and select System Monitor.

Within System Monitor, click on the Add button and choose Microsoft Network Server from the category field. Choose the parameters that you want to track. This will be



System Monitor graphs your system performance

added to the chart. Use this to determine if your system is slowing down on account of shared resources. You may need to disconnect a user or unshare a resource to remedy it.

Win IP Config

Win IP Config can be accessed by going to **Start > Run** and typing in **winipcfg** in the open dialog box. Win IP Config lets you view all your current TCP/IP settings in a single menu. By clicking on More Info, additional information regarding the network can be viewed.

If the IP address was dynamically allocated by a DHCP (Dynamic Host Configuration Protocol) server, then you can use the Release and Renew buttons to release and renew the IP address.

The information displayed on Win IP Config is described below.

Adapter address

This is a hexadecimal address that is unique to every network adapter. It is hard coded into the card by the manufacturer, and consists of six 8-bit numbers. However remember that modems (both internal and external) do not have this address—this is restricted to network adapters while the number for a modem or dial up adapter is set to a meaningless default number.

IP address

This is the current IP networking address. Depending on whether DHCP is used,



See your complete TCP/IP configuration on Win IP Config

this may be static, fixed or dynamically allotted. The static value would be entered in the TCP/IP network configuration menu.

Subnet Mask

This is used to mask a portion of the IP address to determine the subnet where the computer is located, that is, where the computer is located within the internal network. All computers running TCP/IP must have the subnet mask defined.

Default Gateway

This is the IP address of the computer that provides the connection to a remote network. The gateway computer is the computer that TCP/IP will use to communicate and route data destined for computers on remote networks.

On clicking on it for more information, the following settings are displayed.

DHCP Server

This entry indicates the IP address of the DHCP server. The DHCP server, when present, will dynamically

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